MINUTES OF THE CLARE COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS

Approved 11-12-2025

225 W. Main St.
Harrison, Michigan 48625

~~Unapproved~~ minutes
October 15, 2025

Meeting was called to order at 9:00 a.m.

Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America

District 1 Marlene Housler, District 3 Jacob Gross, District 4 Jeff Haskell, District 5 David Hoefling, District 6 Jack Kleinhardt, District 7 Gabe Ambrozaitis and District 8 George Gilmore

COMMISSIONERS ABSENT

District 2 Dale Majewski and District 9 Rick Fancon

OTHERS PRESENT

Clerk & Register of Deeds Lori Mott, Administrator Lori Phelps, Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger, Deputy Clerk Isha Walter, members of the public and zoom participants

APPROVAL OF AGENDA

It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to approve the agenda, **Motion carried.**

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve the Board of Commissioners Minutes of September 17, 2025, the amended Board of Commissioners Closed Session Meeting Minutes of September 17, 2025, the Special Board Meeting Minutes of September 24, 2025 and the Board of Commissioners Minutes of September 30, 2025, **Motion carried**.

GENERAL PUBLIC COMMENT

None

COMMUNICATIONS LIST

1. Letter from Michigan House Representative Tom Kunse – No Discussion
2. News Release Veterans Services – No Discussion
3. Resolution Opposing House of Representatives' FY2026 Budget Cuts to County Revenue Sharing – Montcalm, Wexford and Alpena – No Discussion
4. Resolution Genesee County – No Discussion
    a. Recognizing July as Disability Pride Month
    b. Recognizing September 15 – October 15 as Hispanic Heritage Month
    c. Recognizing October as Indian Heritage Month
5. Lake Level Special Assessment Districts Correspondence – No Discussion
6. Transportation funding distribution per County – No Discussion

ADMINISTRATOR'S REPORT

No report

PUBLIC HEARINGS/SPECIAL PRESENTATIONS

1. Middle Michigan Development Corporation (MMDC)
   Kati Mora, President and CEO of MMDC presented the Board of Commissioners with the 2024 MMDC Annual Report. President Mora also provided an update with the strategic plan for 2025 – 2027. Their continued mission is to support the economy across the Clare County community. Allison Heinrich, Director of Business Development and Attraction highlighted some of the key projects from 2025.

2. Equalization – Pete Preston – Apportionment Report
   Pete Preston, Equalization Director, provided a brief explanation of the Apportionment Report currently under consideration by the Board of Commissioners, which must be approved before submission to the State Tax Commission.

   It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Housler to accept the Apportionment Report as presented and authorize the Equalization Director to spread the tax roll, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (7) being Commissioners Gross, Haskell, Ambrozaitis, Kleinhardt, Housler, Hoefling and Gilmore
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (2) being Commissioners Fancon and Majewski
   Motion carried.

JUSTICE

None

HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

None

PHYSICAL RESOURCES AND ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

1. Drain-Lake Level Presentation and Discussion
   A representative from the Fahey Schultz Burzych Rhodes Law Firm explained the necessity for the five Resolutions presented to the Board of Commissioners for Cranberry Lake, Doc and Tom Lake and Dodge Lake.

   a. It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to adopt Resolution #25-18 Cranberry Lake-Lake Level and #25-19 Doc and Tom Lake-Lake Level approving the computation of costs and special assessment roll as presented by the Clare County Drain Commissioner, roll call vote revealed:

      Yeas: (7) being Commissioners Kleinhardt, Housler, Hoefling, Haskell, Gross, Gilmore and Ambrozaitis
      Nays: (0)
      Absent: (2) being Commissioners Fancon and Majewski
      Motion carried.

   b. It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to adopt Resolution #25-21 Pledging Full Faith and Credit to the Issuance of Notes for Cranberry Lake as presented by the Clare County Drain Commissioner, roll call vote revealed:

      Yeas: (7) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Gilmore, Gross, Haskell, Hoefling, Housler and Kleinhardt
      Nays: (0)
      Absent: (2) being Commissioners Fancon and Majewski
      Motion carried.

PHYSICAL RESOURCES AND ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT - continued

c. It was moved by Commissioner Gross, seconded by Commissioner Haskell to adopt Resolution #25-20 Lake Level Resolution Pursuant to MCL 324.30701, roll call vote revealed:

Yeas: (7) being Commissioners Haskell, Housler, Ambrozaitis, Kleinhardt, Hoefling, Gilmore and Gross
Nays: (0)
Absent: (2) being Commissioners Fancon and Majewski
Motion carried.

2. Clare County Airport (80D) Airport Committee Annual Report
Commissioner Ambrozaitis provided the Board of Commissioners with a Clare County Airport (80D) Committee Annual Report. He announced that the new Airport Manager is Emerson Corder. Commissioner Ambrozaitis discussed external grants, internally funded projects and future development designs and plans.

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION

1. Statutory Finance Committee
It was moved by Commissioner Haskell, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve Statutory Finance Committee meeting minutes of September 15, 2025 in the amount of $143,741.50 and the meeting minutes of September 29, 2025 in the amount of $90,682.06, roll call vote revealed:

Yeas: (7) being Commissioners Hoefling, Kleinhardt, Ambrozaitis, Gross, Gilmore, Haskell and Housler
Nays: (0)
Absent: (2) being Commissioners Fancon and Majewski
Motion carried.

2. Monthly Expenditures
It was moved by Commissioner Gross, seconded by Commissioner Haskell to approve the expenditures for the month of September 2025, in the amount of $3,888,861.78 with the General Fund expenditures totaling $968,331.79, roll call vote revealed:

Yeas: (7) being Commissioners Housler, Gilmore, Kleinhardt, Gross, Ambrozaitis, Hoefling and Haskell
Nays: (0)
Absent: (2) being Commissioners Fancon and Majewski
Motion carried.

CLERK/REGISTER OF DEEDS REPORT

Clerk and Register of Deeds Lori Mott reported that everything is in place for the upcoming November 4, 2025 Special Election. Clare County residents who live in the Harrison and Gladwin Community School Districts will have bond proposals on the ballot. Preparation and training is underway for the 2026 elections with special focus on emergency preparedness and security.

Clerk Mott informed the Commissioners that Dominion sold their voting equipment business to Liberty Vote so Clare County's equipment (which has not been replaced) is now Liberty Vote equipment. Lastly, the Michigan Association of County Clerks recently had a special meeting and unanimously opposed the Ranked Choice Voting proposal largely in part because of its direct conflict with The State Constitution.

TREASURER'S REPORT

Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger provided all the statutory reports to the Commissioners. She reported that they are wrapping up the year end reports. 3,000 delinquent tax notices where recently sent out, which is an average number. Her office is currently researching new dog license software as they are interested in switching. They are also looking into switching the dog license expiration date to end in the month and year of the rabies vaccination expiration date. The 2026 dog licenses are currently being sold in her office.

CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Chairman George Gilmore has attended his meetings. He stated that the Administrator did a wonderful job settling the contract and preparing the budget for next year.

VICE CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Vice Chairman Rick Fancon was absent.

COMMISSIONER'S REPORT

Commissioner Hoefling reported that Franklin Township plans to switch to a new web service provider due to upgrades. The Mid Michigan Community Action Agency continues to monitor the government shutdowns since they rely on State and Federal funding. He also reported that Hamilton Township continues to work on their park.

Commissioner Ambrozaitis reported that the Fall Fly-In was a great event. Eleven aircraft participated including a Bell 505 helicopter from Flint. Airplanes flew in from Alma, Pinconning, Cadillac, Flint and Owosso. He also thanked the twelve volunteers and local businesses that supported the Fly-In event.

Lastly, Commissioner Ambrozaitis reported that he contacted Senator Hauck, Representative Kunse and the Road Commission expressing safety concern for three areas on Business Route 127 in Harrison.

Commissioner Housler thanked Commissioner Ambrozaitis for being transparent with the Airport and for doing a good job. She also commented that the Clare County Transit put in three Electric Vehicle (EV) charging stations. Redding Township now has a full board and Freeman Township plans to hire a new supervisor this month.

Commissioner Kleinhardt announced that the first solar cells in Clare County will be getting started in Arthur Township.

Commissioner Haskell reported that he recently attended a career quest at Saginaw Valley hosted by Michigan Works. The Clare County high school sophomores in attendance learned of alternatives to not getting a bachelor's degree.

Commissioner Gross gave a brief report on Surrey Township and he shared that he will be attending his Substance Abuse Disorder Policy Oversight Board meeting.

Commissioner Majewski was absent.

STATE OF THE COUNTY BUDGET

No report

PUBLIC COMMENT

A member of the public shared his opinion of grant money and Dominion voting equipment.

A Clare County resident commented on the Treasurer's report concerning 3,000 delinquent tax notices.

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None

NEW BUSINESS

None

It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Gross to adjourn, **motion carried.**

Meeting adjourned at 10:04 a.m.

Lori Mott, Clerk
Clare County Board of Commissioners

George Gilmore, Chairman
Clare County Board of Commissioners